2023 Baseball/Softball Rules Quiz

Force Outs/Timing Plays

- With bases loaded and no outs, the batter hits a sharp grounder to the 1st baseman who quickly tags her base and throws home to attempt to get the runner advancing from 3rd. The catcher, with his foot on home plate, catches the ball a full step before the runner crosses the plate. How many outs were recorded on the play?
- With the bases loaded and one out, the batter hits a long fly ball into center field. The center fielder catches it and throws back to the shortstop to double up the runner at 2nd to record the third out. Before the out was recorded at 2nd, the runner from 3rd crossed the plate (after tagging up). Does the run count?

Fair or Foul?

- A low line drive travels over 3rd base and lands just beyond it in foul territory. Fair or foul?
- A grounder with a lot of spin on it bounces along the 3rd base line (touching both foul territory and fair territory) and travels over the bag, coming to rest in foul territory. Fair or foul?
- A fielder reaches into foul territory to field a bouncing ball. Both of the fielder's feet were in fair territory when he made contact with the ball. Fair or foul?
- A fielder making an attempt to catch a ball in fair territory along the 3rd base line boots the ball into foul territory (before the ball has reached a 3rd base). Fair or foul?
- The batter swings at a pitch, fouling it back to the catcher's mitt, but the catcher drops it. A runner at 1st, seeing the catcher drop the ball, takes off for 2nd and makes it. What, if anything, do you do?

- Same as above but the catcher catches the ball (i.e., a foul tip). What, if anything, do you do?
- A pitch behind the batter strikes the bat accidentally as the batter was ducking out of the way (i.e., the batter did not swing). The ball rolls into fair territory. What, if anything, do you do?

Interference/Obstruction

- A runner goes well outside the basepath to avoid an infielder who is awaiting a throw from an outfielder. The infielder catches the ball an instant later, then swoops around but misses the tag. The runner makes the next base safely. What, if anything, do you do?
- Same as above but the fielder successfully applies the tag on the runner. What, if anything, do you do?
- Same as above but the infielder is attempting to field a batted ball when the runner goes well outside the basepath to avoid contact with the fielder. The fielder throws out the runner. What, if anything, do you do?
- Waiting for a throw from the shortstop on a batted ball, the 1st baseman stands on top of the bag. The batter/runner approaching 1st visibly slows down to avoid contact with the 1st baseman. The throw beats the runner but, in your judgment, had the batter/runner continued running at full speed to an empty base, he would have beat the throw. Do you award the batter/runner 1st base on obstruction?
- The catcher fields a bunt out in front of the plate but does not attempt a throw to 1st because the batter/runner is running inside the 1st baseline (i.e., is not in the running lane) and would likely be struck by the catcher's throw. Is the batter/runner out on interference?
- Same as above, but this time the catcher does attempt a throw and hits the runner in the back. The batter/runner reaches 1st safely. In addition, a runner who started the play at 2nd base reaches 3rd. What, if anything, do you do?

- In an attempt to turn a double play, the shortstop steps on 2nd, but his throw to 1st hits the runner approaching 2nd. You don't believe the runner intentionally got in the way of the throw, nor that the fielder intentionally hit the runner. What, if anything, do you do?
- Same as above except the shortstop eats the ball to avoid hitting the runner approaching from 1st. What, if anything, do you do?
- A baserunner approaching 3rd base is hit in the back by a thrown ball coming in from right field and, as a result, reaches 3rd base. What, if anything, do you do?
- In what situations is a baserunner required to slide into a base to avoid interfering with a fielder?

Hit By Pitch

- An inside pitch hits the batter on the hands gripping the bat as she's trying to get out of the way of the ball. Is she awarded 1st base on a hit-by-pitch?
- An inside pitch hits the batter on the hands while he is swinging at the pitch. Is he awarded 1st base on a hit-by-pitch?
- Same as the above but the batter is struck on the hands while *not* swinging. The hands were in the strike zone when the ball hit them. Is the batter awarded 1st base on a hit-by-pitch?